

MIDDLE SCHOOL HACKS

WONDER

Every ministry is different. Whether you're teaching middle schoolers, high schoolers, teenagers with disabilities, or all three, here's how to hack this series to fit your unique and diverse audience.

REMEMBER

Middle schoolers are deeply influenced by their peers and sensitive to others' opinions and may find the vulnerability of worship intimidating. Throughout *Wonder*, it's crucial to foster a safe, judgment-free environment where they feel supported. This not only encourages participation but also helps them realize that worship can be a powerful way to express their genuine emotions—whether joy, sadness, or confusion—before God.

REVISE

To make this series more accessible for middle schoolers, here's what to adjust...

- **For every discussion question, start by sharing your own answers as concrete examples.** Middle schoolers are more likely to open up when they see vulnerability modeled first.
- **In Week 1's "Summit Everest" activity, adjust the obstacle course to make it less about speed and more about teamwork.** Make it a challenge where each guide helps their climber complete tasks.
- **In Week 2, provide extra support from leaders during the "Write to Remember" response.** Scaffold this activity with examples they can borrow inspiration from.
- **In Week 3's "Niagara River Relay," make the challenge more structured by setting clear rules for moving through the course.** Having clear boundaries and guidelines will ensure younger students stay engaged and safe.
- **In Week 4, provide examples of the different ways healing happens for the question, "When do you ask for healing?"** Since abstract thinking is still developing in middle schoolers, this will help expand their scope and application.

REPLACE

And here are the Building Blocks you may want to swap for something else...

- **In the story in Week 3, have a high school student share instead of an adult.** This will help engage your older teenagers, and your middle school teenagers love hearing from older students.